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India's inventive approach should be labelled 'Gohit' after their skipper

We have seen over the last couple of years that Rohit Sharma has been **batting aggressively** and encouraging his team to do so as well. If any credit is due, it is solely to Rohit.

India's batting in the recently concluded Test match at Kanpur's Green Park has come in for universal praise for breathing life into a game that seemed destined to be dead and buried. **Rohit Sharma, the Indian skipper who has led the revolution in batting approach since taking over as captain, once again showed the way forward.** The first two deliveries he faced [in the first innings] were smashed for sixes, and the innings gained momentum at breakneck speed from thereon. To be fair, young Yashasvi Jaiswal also hammered three boundaries in the very first over of the innings, but those could be described as risk-free punches. Rohit, on the other hand, took a risk as he advanced down the pitch to the very first delivery he faced, smiting it over long-on for a mighty six. When the bowler shortened his length for the next delivery, it was pulled over square leg for another maximum. This completely threw the Bangladesh bowlers off, and the others that followed just didn't know where to bowl.

Not surprisingly, the Indian approach drew reactions from the old powers who, as usual, wanted to take credit for it. That's how certain parts of the world work in everyday life, too — taking credit where none is really due. Sadly, while the batting was thrilling and refreshing,

the names given to the approach were the same old, same old. Just as any scandal is now called this-gate or that-gate after the Watergate scandal over 50 years ago in the United States of America, this Indian batting approach was labelled this-ball and that-ball after the term 'Bazball' was coined for the England team's batting attitude. It was called this because *Baz* is the nickname of their coach, Brendon McCullum from New Zealand, who batted exactly as his team is doing — throwing caution to the winds in an attempt to score runs.

As seen in India last year, this approach doesn't work in Test matches and may surprise the opposition for a game or two at best. While one paper called the Indian batting 'Bossball' because the captain or 'boss' of the team, Rohit, had shown the way, some from the old powers referred to it as 'Gamball' after the Indian coach, Gautam Gambhir. While the England batting approach changed completely under the new regime of Ben Stokes and McCullum, we have seen over the last couple of years that Rohit has been batting like this and encouraging his team to do so as well. Gambhir has only been coaching for a couple of months, so attributing this approach to him is foot-licking of the highest quality. Gambhir himself hardly ever batted in this fashion like